UX EVALUATION & REDESIGN · BEAUTY SHOPPING FLOW

Purplle

The first-time shade shopper is where this flow loses orders. Two of eight issues cost sales directly. Fixing the biggest one costs Purplle money, and this deck says how I would test that.

WHO IS SHOPPING

First-time shade buyer in a smaller town. Price-sensitive, cannot swatch in a store, buying a lipstick online. My screenshots carry a delivery pin of Uthangarai 635207, Tamil Nadu.

Persona, based on hands-on use of the app.

WHY HER, NOT A REPEAT BUYER

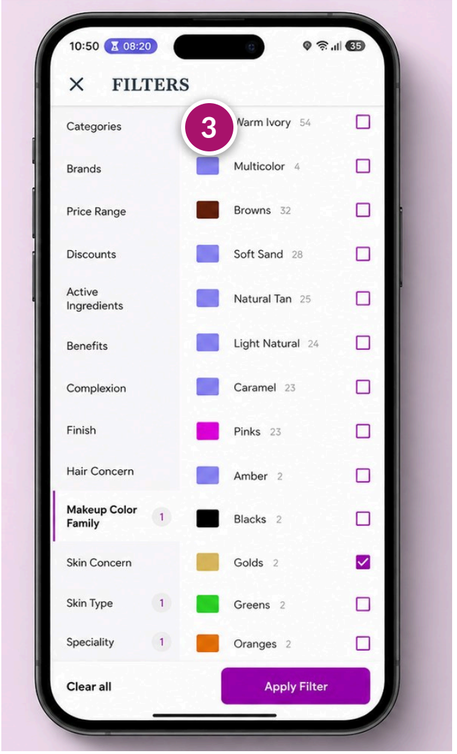
A repeat buyer restocking a known shade searches by name and goes straight to Add to cart. She never opens filters or category browsing. The first-time shopper meets every friction in this deck: filters, shade swatches, stock status, cart promotions.

FLOW EVALUATED Home → Search / Category → Product Listing → Filters → Product → Shade / Qty → Cart → Proceed to Pay

Screens captured: Home to Cart. Shipping and payment steps were not captured, so I make no claims about them.

Current experience (1 of 2): finding a shade

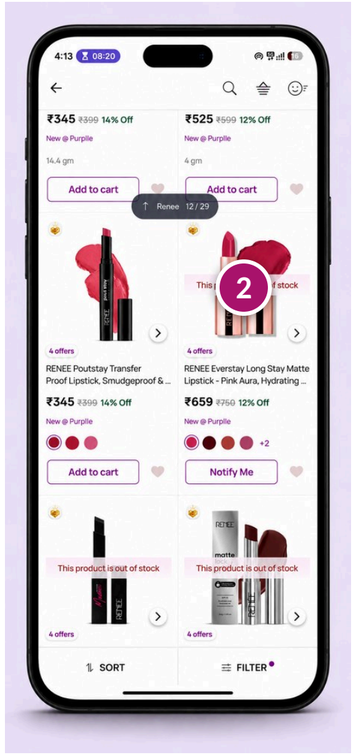
Numbers match the ranking on slide 4.



MATCH TO REAL WORLD

Swatches don’t match their names

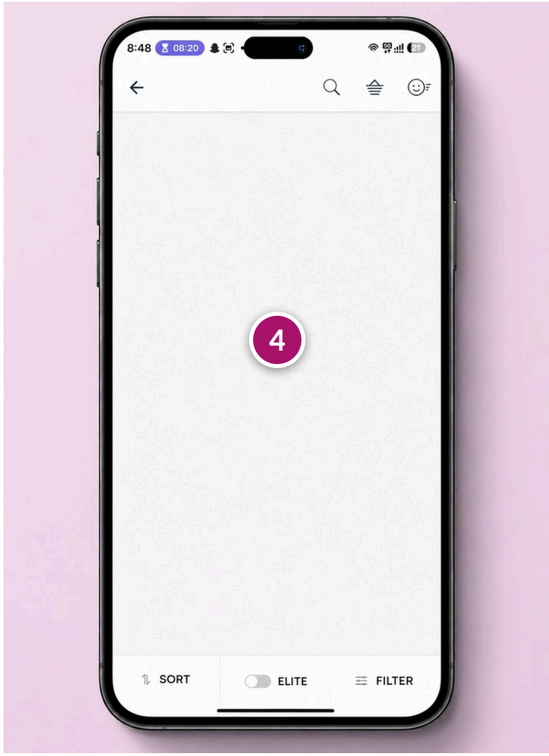
Warm Ivory, Multicolor, Soft Sand, Natural Tan, Light Natural, Caramel and Amber all show the same purple chip. Browns, Golds and Greens show real colours. The list also has no Availability option.



ERROR PREVENTION

Out-of-stock tiles sit among buyable ones

3 of the 6 products on this screen are out of stock. They look like the rest, and she finds out only after tapping in.



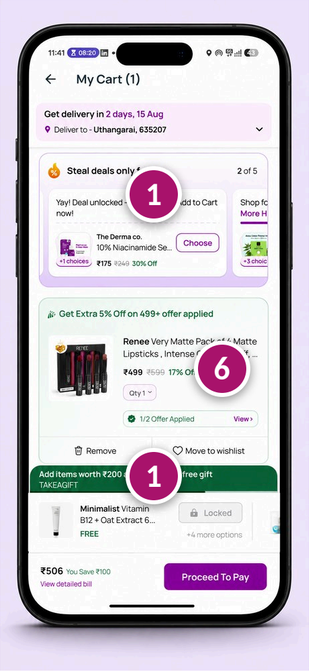
VISIBILITY OF SYSTEM STATUS

Blank screen while a listing loads

An empty white page with no spinner, skeleton or retry. She cannot tell if the app is working or broken. Seen intermittently, not on every load.

Current experience (2 of 2): choosing and carting

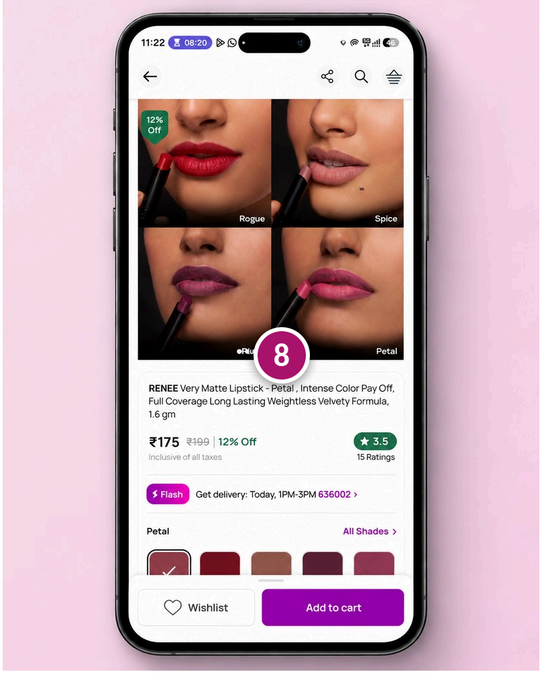
Cart, product page and category navigation, plus one issue I could only reproduce by tapping.



MINIMALIST DESIGN · HICK'S LAW

Cart pulls attention off paying

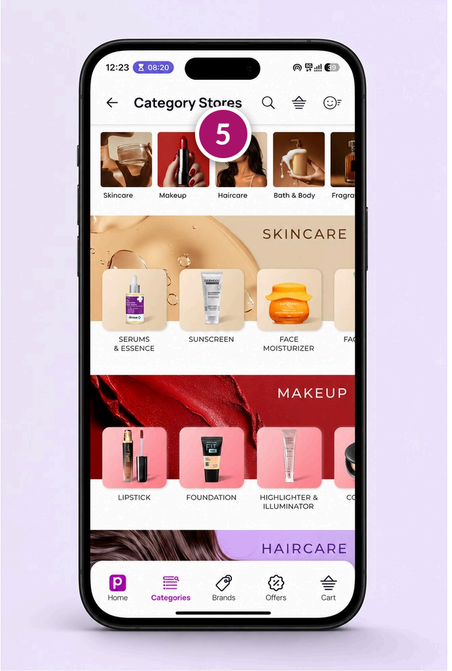
Deal carousel, offer banner and a gift-unlock bar all sit above Proceed to Pay. The quantity box shows "Qty 1" with no stock limit (6).



PROXIMITY

Carousel dots sit on the product info

The shade-photo dots touch the title and price block, so they read as part of it.



JAKOB'S LAW

Extra "Category Stores" layer

Tapping Categories lands on a campaign-style page before any product list.

#7, no screenshot: Home → 80th Independence Deals → tap the large arrow (›). Nothing happens. Steps to reproduce, not a captured screen.

Eight findings, ranked by what they cost an order

Severity = does it block or divert a purchase. “Fires” is read off the flow and my screenshots, not analytics.

#	Issue	Severity	How often it fires	Heuristic	UX law	Fix
1	**Cart promotions overload**	High	Every cart view, one tap before payment	Aesthetic & Minimalist	Hick’s Law	Collapse (slide 5)
2	**Out-of-stock mixed in listing**	High	Every listing with stock gaps (3 of 6 tiles)	Error Prevention	Hick’s Law	In Stock filter
3	**Swatch ≠ name**	Med	Each time the colour filter opens	Match system & real world	Information scent	Map swatches
4	**Blank loading state**	Med	Intermittent, but a dead end when it hits	Visibility of system status	None	Skeleton + retry
5	**Category Stores layer**	Med	Every category tap	Consistency & standards	Jakob’s Law	Straight to list
6	**Qty / stock limit unclear**	Med	Only limited-stock items	Error Prevention	None	“Only N left”
7	**Dead deals arrow**	Low	Each tap on that screen	Visibility of system status	Jakob’s Law	Fix or remove
8	**Carousel crowds shade info**	Low	Every product page	Aesthetic & Minimalist	Proximity	Add spacing

Ranking logic: the dead arrow is Low because it wastes a tap but never blocks an order. It is a mismatch between a control that looks tappable and a system that gives no response, so it sits under Visibility of system status, not Consistency. Category Stores is Medium: it adds a step, not a dead end.

The call: declutter the cart, and accept what it costs

Issue #1 is the one where two heuristics genuinely conflict.

The conflict

- **Visibility of system status** says show every offer and how close she is to the free gift. The goal-gradient effect makes “add ₹200 more, get a gift” pull people to add items.
- **Aesthetic & Minimalist design** (and Hick’s Law) says the cart has one job: confirm item, price, delivery, pay.

My ruling: minimalist wins, with one exception

- Status that changes her price stays visible: offer applied, savings, total.
- Status that asks for a new decision (deal carousels, gift-unlock bar) moves behind one row that still reads “3 offers · save up to ₹250”. She can see it exists. She is not forced to decide on it.
- Why: she is price-sensitive and new. A screen that asks her to choose again just before paying gives her a reason to leave.

What it costs

Those widgets are where Purplle earns add-on revenue. Collapsing them may lower items per order and gift-led basket building. This is a revenue decision, not a UX cleanup.

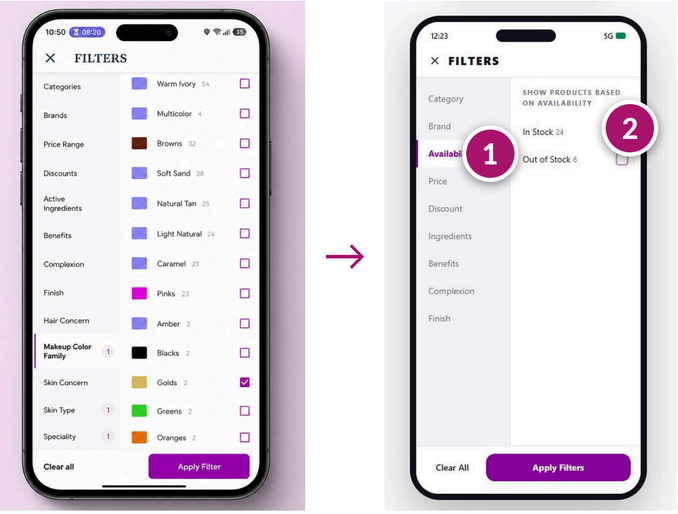
How I would test it

- **A** control · **B** collapsed row (my redesign) · **C** collapsed row plus the single offer nearest to unlocking, shown inline.
- **Primary metric:** revenue per cart view (cart-to-payment rate × order value). Not conversion alone.
- **Guardrails:** items per order, free-gift redemption.
- **Stop rule:** stop B if revenue per cart view is more than 2% below A. The 2% is the planned threshold; set it from Purplle’s baseline and traffic.
- **Hypothesis:** C matches or beats A. If so, ship C and keep B as the fallback.

Redesign: before → after, annotated

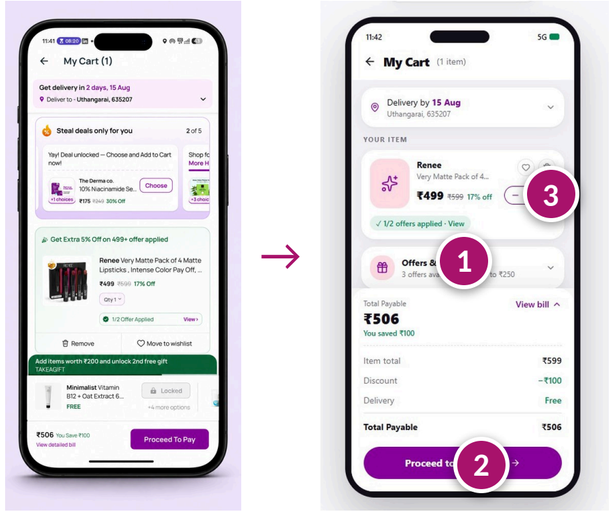
Each number names the issue it resolves.

FILTERS: IN STOCK ONLY



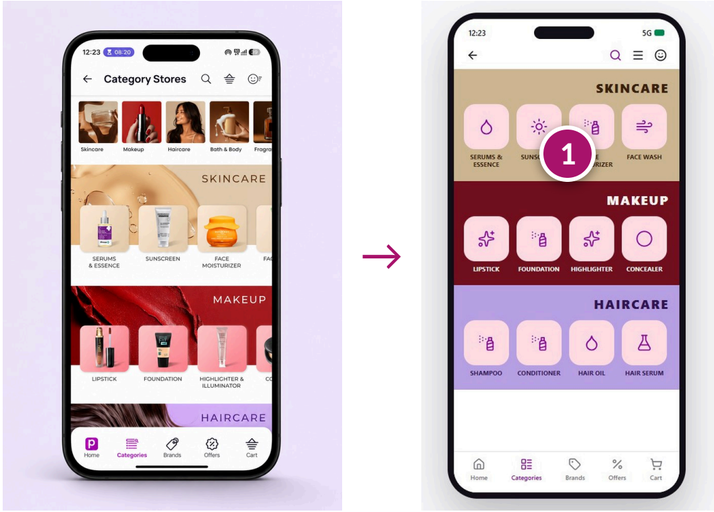
1 New Availability tab. Fixes **#2**.
2 In Stock ticked by default, and "Out of Stock 6" still shown so nothing is hidden silently.

CART: DECLUTTERED



1 Offers collapsed to one row. Fixes **#1**.
2 Total and Proceed to Pay now carry the weight.
3 Stepper replaces "Qty 1". "Only N left" text goes under it (**#6**, not mocked).

CATEGORY NAVIGATION



1 Category tiles go straight to the product list. The campaign layer drops to a secondary tab. Fixes **#5**.

Not mocked: swatch fix (#3) is a catalogue data change, skeleton states (#4) and carousel spacing (#8) are small visual changes.

What ships first

Cheap, low-risk fixes first. The revenue-sensitive change goes through a test. Effort sizes are my estimates for engineering to confirm.

Wave	Change	Issue	Effort	Success signal
1 · now	In Stock filter, out-of-stock tiles sorted last	#2	S	Taps landing on out-of-stock products fall
1 · now	Skeleton loading plus error with Try Again	#4	S	Exits from blank listing screens fall
1 · now	Fix or remove the deals arrow; “Only N left” under quantity	#7, #6	XS, S	Dead taps gone; fewer stock errors at checkout
2 · test	Cart promotions A/B/C from slide 5	#1	M	Revenue per cart view vs control, with the stop rule
2 · ops	Map every colour swatch to its name in the catalogue	#3	S–M	Colour filter use goes up, shade returns go down
3 · later	Category Stores as secondary; spacing under carousel dots	#5, #8	L, S	Category-to-listing steps drop from 2 to 1

Why this order: Wave 1 touches no revenue and fixes the two issues that send her to dead ends. Wave 2 needs sign-off because it risks add-on revenue. Wave 3 changes navigation that the merchandising team owns, so it needs their input and costs the most.

Public evidence and sources

One public user post confirms the cart failure is real. The findings table keeps its own frequency column, which I read from the flow, not from analytics.

#	Source (date)	What it says	How it is used
[1]	**ConsumerComplaints.in**, user post, 9 Aug 2026 (public user voice, one post) consumercomplaints.in/purplle-com-i-am-unable-to-place-an-order-c3543923	“I am unable to place an order because an out-of-stock freebie is automatically added to my cart.” “There is no option to remove the freebie.”	Same two failures as findings #1 and #2, seen by another user: cart promotions and stock gaps block a purchase. One post shows the failure exists, not how often it fires.
[2]	**Jakob Nielsen, 10 Usability Heuristics** (Nielsen Norman Group) nngroup.com/articles/ten-usability-heuristics/ · principles.design/examples/10-usability-heuristics-for-user-interface-design	Defines Visibility of system status, Error prevention, Match between system and real world, Aesthetic and minimalist design, Consistency and standards.	Heuristic column of the findings table and the conflict on slide 5.
[3]	**Maze, “UX laws”**, 10 Jun 2021 maze.co/collections/ux-ui-design/ux-laws/	Hick’s Law: more options, less likely to choose. Jakob’s Law: users expect your site to work like others. Law of Proximity: close elements read as one group.	UX-law column of the findings table.

One rule added from [1]

An unavailable free gift must never block checkout: remove it automatically and show a short note. This is Error prevention. Add it to wave 1 and track **orders blocked by an unavailable freebie = 0** as a guardrail on the cart test.